d) What if you want to create a chain of directories and sub-directories, something like */tmp/our/your/mine*?

Remedy: Try this:

```
$ mkdir -p /tmp/our/your/mine
```

e) One very interesting way to combine some related commands is with *&&*.

```
$ cd dir_name && ls -alr && cd ..
```

f) Now for some fun! Have you ever tried checking the vulnerability of your Linux system? Try a fork-bomb to evaluate this:

```
$ :(){ :|: & };:
```

It's actually a shell function; look closely and it's an unnamed function *:()* with the body enclosed in *{}*. The statement ':|:' makes a call to the function itself and pipes the output to another function call—thus we are calling the function twice. *&* puts all processes in the background and hence you can't kill any process. Finally ';' completes the function definition and the last ':' initiates a call to this unnamed function. So it recursively creates processes and eventually your system will hang. This is one of the most dangerous Linux commands and may cause your computer to crash!

Remedy: How to avoid a fork bomb? Of course, by limiting the process limit; you need to edit */etc/security/limits.conf*. Edit the variable ***nproc*** to ***user_name hard nproc 100***. You require root privileges to modify this file.

g) One more dirty way to hack into the system is through continuous reboots, resulting in the total breakdown of a Linux machine. Here's an option that you need root access for. Edit the file */etc/inittab* and modify the line ***id:5:initdefault:*** to ***id:6:initdefault:***. That's all! Linux specifies various user modes and 6 is intended for reboot. Hence, your machine keeps on rebooting every time it checks for the default user mode.

Remedy: Modify your ***Grub*** configuration (the Linux bootloader) and boot in single user mode. Edit the file */etc/inittab* and change the default user level to 5.

I hope you'll have some fun trying out these commands, and that they bring you closer to Linux. Please do share your feedback and comments. END

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...continued from page 25: Stop Wasting CDs

Figure 3: Select the partition and the sub-directory where the ISO image resides

Figure 4: Fedora 9 installation in action

After this, it picks up the Anaconda installer of Fedora 9 (or any other installer, as in your case) from the prescribed location, and proceeds with the regular installation procedure just like you'd get if you were installing from a bootable optical media. Follow the steps as you would to install the distro. Figure 4 shows the package installation in action. After that's done, reboot and you'll be able to use your newly installed operating system.

Easy enough, right? So, I hope you'll start using this simple trick to install the newly released GNU/Linux distros and stop worrying about whether you have the required blank optical media. And the additional environmental benefit is less use of non-biodegradable plastic materials (which is what a CD/DVD is made out of). END

By: Sandeep Yadav

The author is a part of the LFY CD team and loves to run *./configure && make && make* install every now and then.